

Section One: Research Goals

-Who Are My Users?

Students/Young Professionals,Freelancers,Low Income People.(18-35)

-What Problem Do They Face With Saving / Investing?

- Low Saving Discipline
- Low Income
- High Minimum Requirement for investment
- Complexity and Takes Too Much time.

-What Do They Want In A Finance App?

- Secure -User Friendly -Flexible -Clear Explanations & Transparency
- Education & Guidance -Good Customer Support

Problems	Solutions
-People Find it hard to track and manage their money	-Provide a simple,all-in-one view of spending and savings
-Users struggle to save consistently	-Introduce effortless,automatic saving methods
-People worry about hidden fees or security	-Ensure transparency and security measures
-Users feel stressed and overwhelmed by money management	-Create a calming , user-friendly design that reduces pressure
-People lose interest in money apps over time	-Add progress tracking and small rewards to keep users engaged
-Many apps feel confusing or overly complex	-Build a clear, intuitive flow with minimal steps
-Existing apps feel similar and uninspiring	-Offer personalization and fresh , user-centered design touches

Section Two: Methodology

1-Surveys

Objective

To gather data on users’ saving/investing habits, frustrations, motivations, and feature preferences—grounding design decisions in real needs and expectations

Method

An online survey was built using Google Forms and circulated through personal and social networks. It included multiple-choice questions focused on financial behavior, existing tools, pain points, trust factors , motivations, and demographics. A total of 25 participants responded

Key Findings

- A significant number of users don’t feel confident about managing money due to complexity, lack of transparency, or high fees.
- Top priorities for a new app include automation, security, and simple entry points.
- Trust is driven by clear explanations, secure logins, and credible affiliations.
- Motivators for saving include visual progress, balance growth, and rewards.
- Most participants are open to investing modest sums monthly, and many are willing to pay a small fee if the app delivers value.

Insights

-Users clearly favor simplicity and automation—they despise complexity and unpredictability. Security, transparency, and trust go hand in hand with usability. Visual cues and small achievements are powerful motivators.

Impact On Design

These insights shaped the early-phase design strategy:

- Emphasis on automation, making saving feel effortless.
- Use of trust-building UI elements: transparency, secure auth, and credible affiliations.
- Designing visual motivators—like trackers and rewards—to maintain engagement.
- Maintaining low friction entry points, especially for new users.

2-Interviews

Objective

While the survey provided valuable quantitative data, I conducted user interviews to gain deeper insights into personal experiences, emotions, and motivations related to saving and investing.

Method

I carried out 5 semi-structured interviews with participants aged 20–32. Each session lasted approximately 20 minutes and explored participants' financial habits, pain points with existing tools, and expectations for a new solution.

Key Questions Asked

- How do you currently manage your savings or investments?
- What challenges do you face when trying to save or invest?
- Have you used financial apps before? If yes, what worked well and what didn't?
- What would make you trust a new finance app?
- What features or experiences would motivate you to save more consistently?

Key Insights

From the interviews, several themes consistently emerged:

- Saving money feels stressful for many users, leading to delays or avoidance.
- Existing apps are often perceived as too complex and overwhelming.
- Trust and transparency are critical, especially regarding fees and data security.
- Users want automation for convenience but also value control and clarity.
- Visual progress indicators (e.g., goals, trackers) were seen as highly motivating.

Impact On Design

These insights directly shaped the design direction of the project:

- Building a simple, trustworthy, and transparent interface.
- Prioritizing features that balance automation with user control
- Introducing visual progress elements to make saving feel achievable and rewarding.

3-Competitor Analysis

Objective

To understand the strengths and gaps in existing saving and investing apps, I analyzed Acorns, Raiz, and Moneybox, Which are well-known for round-up savings and beginner investing.

Selected Competitors

Acorns - U.S.-based app focusing on round-up savings and micro-investing.

Raiz - Similar to Acorns, popular in Australia, with diversified investing options.

MoneyBox - U.K.-based,focused on saving goals and beginner-friendly investments.

Feature/ Competitor	Acorns	Raiz	Moneybox
Core Offering	Round-up savings +micro-investing	Round-Ups + diversified investments	Round-ups + goal-based saving & investing
Target Users	Beginners in the U.S.	Beginners in Australia	Beginners in The U.K.
Round-Up Savings	✔ Yes	✔ Yes	✔ Yes
Goal Setting	✖ Limited	✖ Limited	✔ Strong goal-based dashboards
Dashboards/ Visualization	✔ Simple	✖ Dated	✔ Clean,goal-focused
Investment Options	ETFs,Portfolios	ETFs,Portfolios, some Education	ETFs,Savings accounts ,ISAs
Cash-Back/ Found Money	✔ Partner brands add money to investments	✖ No	✖ No
Fees	Flat fee (\$3–\$5/month), high for small balances	% fee (approx. 0.275%)	Tiered fees, some features locked
Trust & Transparency	✔ Strong brand	✔ Regulated, but UX dated	✔ Regulated, beginner -friendly
UX/UI	✔ Simple for beginners	✖ Outdated visuals	✔ Modern & friendly
Strengths	Automation, brand trust , beginner focus	Balanced portfolios, local presence	Goal-based saving, clean design
Weaknesses	High fees for small savers, limited control	Outdated UI, less engaging	Limited flexibility, subscription walls

Section Three: Findings(Painpoints + Insights)

PainPoints	Insights
Fee Opacity For Small Balances,Fees are Hidden & confusing	Effective Fee % By Balance & Alerts when it's high
OnBoarding Overload	Progressive Education
Glitches Around Corporate Actions(Splits/Dividends)	Corporate Actions Center With explanations & Timestamps
Users Fear Scams	Show Security Badges +License Info ,Approvals Display
No Motivation to keep saving	Goal-Based Saving (Set Trips,Phone,emergencies)
Hard To Track Progress	Visual Dashboard With Insights
Feels boring	Gamification & Rewards (Badges,Streaks,Progress bar)
Local context (Egypt doesn't allow stock apps)	Gold Wallet / Government Bonds Options
People want to learn but not read boring stuff	Financial Literacy Tips (micro-lessons + visuals)
Poor Customer Support	AI Support Bot & call,FAQs

Section Four: Design Implications/ideation (How Insights Shaped My App Idea)

Insight	Design Implication	Feature Direction
Users find investing too complex	Remove jargon, guide step by step	Onboarding Quiz → asks simple lifestyle questions → suggests one of 3 portfolios (Safe / Balanced / Growth)
Fear of losing money makes people hesitant	Give them control & safety	Emergency Withdraw Button on dashboard → allows instant transfer back to bank
Hidden fees cause distrust	Show all costs clearly	Fees Panel in settings/dashboard → shows exact subscription cost in EGP
Saving feels boring and unmotivating	Make saving fun & personal	Goal-Setting Feature (trip, emergency, phone) + Gamification (badges, streak rewards)
Users want to see results visually	Show progress in charts	Dashboard with Progress Bar + Pie/Line Charts showing balance & goal completion
Stock/ETF investing not available in Egypt	Use legal, local options	Gold Wallet + Government Bonds Wallet instead of stocks
People want to learn but not through boring text	Teach in bite-sized chunks	Learn Section → daily financial tip card with illustration/animation
Users need flexible ways to save	Offer multiple deposit methods	Saving Options: Round-ups, Recurring deposits, Manual top-ups
Users like accountability & community	Add social layer	Saving Challenges with Friends (e.g., save 200 EGP in 10 days)
People worry about scams	Show proof of security	Security Badge on home screen ("Secured by X Bank") + 2FA login
Too many choices overwhelm users	Reduce decision fatigue	Only 3 Saving Plans (Safe, Balanced, Growth) instead of many complicated ones
Users want personalized help	App should feel like a coach	Smart Recommendations → app nudges: "You spent less this week , save 30 EGP?"

